Questions put to the Talmud

Twenty-six questions drawn from the author's own writing,
run against 81,481 segments of the English Talmud Bavli

Retrieved twice: by `bge-base-en-v1.5` before fine-tuning,
and by `torah-embed` after. No gold answers exist for these questions —
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1. Why would God tell Abraham to sacrifice his firstborn son when God had already promised Abraham more children than the stars?

nick-alexar.tex, Trust (verbatim)
torah-embed:

- **Taanit 4a:10** The Gemara interprets each phrase of this verse: Which I did not command, this is referring to the son of Mesha, king of Moab. King Mesha sacrificed his son, as it is stated: Then he took his firstborn son, who would reign after him, and he offered him as a burnt-offering (II Kings 3:27). And I did not speak, this is refer…
- **Sanhedrin 89b:11** God said to Abraham: Please take your son, your only, whom you love, Isaac (Genesis 22:2). When God said: Your son, Abraham said: I have two sons. When God said: Your only, Abraham said: This son is an only son to his mother, and that son is an only son to his mother. When God said: Whom you love, Abraham said: I love bo…
- **Nedarim 32a:9** The Gemara expounds the verse and He brought him outside (Genesis 15:5): Abraham said before Him: Master of the Universe, I looked at my constellation and according to it I will have only one son, and a son has already been born to me, i.e., Ishmael. He said to him: Emerge from your astrology because there is no constellation…

before fine-tuning:

- **Nedarim 32a:9** The Gemara expounds the verse and He brought him outside (Genesis 15:5): Abraham said before Him: Master of the Universe, I looked at my constellation and according to it I will have only one son, and a son has already been born to me, i.e., Ishmael. He said to him: Emerge from your astrology because there is no constellation…

2. Why did Jacob change his name to Israel?

nick-alexar.tex, The struggle with God (verbatim)
torah-embed (top hit unchanged by fine-tuning):

- **Berakhot 13a:1** not that the name Jacob will be entirely uprooted from its place, but that the name Israel will be the primary name to which the name Jacob will be secondary, as the Torah continues to refer to him as Jacob after this event. And it also says that the ultimate redemption will overshadow the previous redemption in the verse: Do n…
- **Berakhot 13a:4** Having mentioned the changing of Jacobs name, the Gemara addresses the changing of the names of Abraham and Sarah. What is the meaning of changing Abrams name to Abraham? As it is stated: Abram is Abraham (I Chronicles 1:27)…
- **Berakhot 13a:11** Again, the Gemara asks: But if that is so, one who calls Jacob Jacob, about whom it is written: Your name shall no longer be Jacob, but Israel (Genesis 32:29), also transgresses a mitzva…

3. Will the Messiah come and rebuild the Temple?

nick-alexar.tex, closing (verbatim)
torah-embed (top hit unchanged by fine-tuning):

- **Megillah 17b:20** And once Jerusalem is rebuilt, the Messiah, scion of the house of David, will come, as it is stated:...
- **Sanhedrin 97b:7** And the Messiah will come not in accordance with the opinion of Rabbi Akiva, who would interpret the verse: Yet once, it is a little while, and I will shake the heavens and the earth (Haggai 2:6), to mean that the redemption would transpire soon after the destruction of the Temple....
- **Sanhedrin 97a:1** the Tabernacle of David that is fallen [hanofelet] (Amos 9:11). That is why the Messiah is called bar nifli. Rabbi Yitzak said to him that this is what Rabbi Yoanan says: During the generation in which the Messiah, son of David, comes, Torah scholars decrease; and as for the rest of the people, their eyes fail with sorrow and...

4. If Abraham had gone through with it, would the inheritance have passed to Ishmael instead?

nick-alexar.tex, The firstborn question
torah-embed:

- **Sotah 13b:2** The Gemara asks: And if Moses had not dealt with the burial of Joseph, would the Jewish people not have dealt with it? But isnt it written that after Moses died: And the bones of Joseph, which the children of Israel brought up out of Egypt, they buried in Shechem (Joshua 24:32), which indicates that the Jewish people complete...
- **Sanhedrin 91a:14** The Gemara relates: And on another occasion, the descendants of Ishmael and the descendants of Keturah came to judgment with the Jewish people before Alexander of Macedon. They said to the Jewish people before Alexander: The land of Canaan is both ours and yours, as it is written: And these are the generations of Ishmael, son o...
- **Nedarim 31a:6** GEMARA: The Gemara asks: And is a Jew excluded from the category of the descendants of Noah? They are also descendants of Noah. The Gemara answers: Since Abraham was sanctified and designated to possess a unique role in the world, all his descendants are called by his name and are no longer termed the descendants of Noah....

before fine-tuning:

- **Bava Batra 116a:16** ğ The mishna teaches that this is the principle: Concerning anyone who precedes another with regard to inheritance, his descendants precede the other as well, and a father precedes all of his descendants. Rami bar ama raises a dilemma: With regard to the claim of a father of the deceaseds father and the claim of the brother of...

5. Who counts as the firstborn - the son born first, or the son of the first wife?

nick-alexar.tex, The firstborn question
torah-embed:

- **Yevamot 24a:20** The Gemara asks: But if there is no difference between the firstborn and the eldest, why does the Merciful One call the brother who enters levirate marriage the firstborn?...
- **Bekhorot 47b:15** ğ The mishna teaches that Rabbi Shimon says: The first son is a firstborn with regard to inheritance if he is his fathers first son, and the second son is a firstborn with

regard to redemption from a priest for five sela coins. The Gemara explains: The verse states: And they have borne him children, and a caesarean section is...

- **Bekhorot 46a:10** In the case of one who had sons and married a woman who had not given birth; or if he married a woman who converted while she was pregnant, or a Canaanite maidservant who was emancipated while she was pregnant and she gave birth to a son, he is a firstborn with regard to redemption from a priest, as he opened his mothers womb,...

before fine-tuning:

- **Bekhorot 47b:14** Similarly, the second son who follows him is not considered the firstborn with regard to inheritance, as we require fulfillment of the verse: For he is the first of his strength, the right of the firstborn is his (Deuteronomy 21:17), and this son is not the first. In addition, he is also not considered the firstborn with regar...

6. Jacob tricked his father into giving him the blessing meant for his older brother. Was that blessing still valid?

nick-alexar.tex, The firstborn question
torah-embed:

- **Megillah 13b:2** The Gemara explains: What was the modesty shown by Rachel? It is as it is written: And Jacob told Rachel that he was her fathers brother, and that he was Rebeccas son (Genesis 29:12). It may be asked: Was he, Jacob, in fact her fathers brother? But wasnt he the son of her fathers sister?...
- **Bava Batra 123a:18** The Gemara now explains the second part of Rabbi Yonatans explanation: And what was a demonstration of the modesty that Rachel possessed? As it is written: And Jacob told Rachel that he was her fathers brother, and that he was Rebeccas son (Genesis 29:12). The Gemara asks: But isnt he the son of her fathers sister? Why di...
- **Bava Batra 123a:19** Jacob said to her: What is his method of deceit of which I need be aware? Rachel said to him: I have a sister who is older than me, and he will not marry me off before he marries her off, even if he promises that he will do so. Jacob said to her: I am his brother, i.e., equal, in deceit, and he will not be able to deceive me. Th...

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7. Why is a child Jewish if the mother is Jewish, but not if only the father is?

nick-alexar.tex, Matrilineal descent
torah-embed:

- **Yevamot 17a:2** Rav Yehuda continued his recounting: When I said this halakha, that there is a concern about the betrothal of gentiles nowadays, before Shmuel, he said to me: One need not worry about this, as your son from a Jewish woman is called your son, i.e., he inherits his lineage from you, and your son from a gentile woman is not called...
- **Bekhorot 47a:13** Rather, Rav Adda bar Ahava must be referring to a case where the daughter of a Levite became pregnant from an Israelite. But if so, why is the sons status determined by his mothers status in this instance? After all, it is written: By their families, by their fathers houses (Numbers 1:2), which indicates that the lineage of...

- **Yevamot 23a:11** The Gemara answers: Rabbi Yoanan said in the name of Rabbi Shimon ben Yoai: The verse states: Neither shall you make marriages with them: Your daughter you shall not give unto his son, nor his daughter shall you take unto your son, for he will turn away your son from following Me (Deuteronomy 7:34). This teaches that your s...

before fine-tuning:

- **Yevamot 23a:9** Conversely, if it would teach us only the case of a gentile woman, one might say that this is because she does not have any connection with the mitzvot and therefore her children are in no way Jewish. But since a Canaanite maidservant has a connection with the mitzvot, as she is obligated to observe the prohibitions in the same...

8. Why is it forbidden to say God's name out loud?

nick-alexar.tex, The unpronounceable name
torah-embed:

- **Temurah 4a:1** The Gemara responds: You cannot say that Deuteronomy 28:59 is referring to one who pronounces the name of Heaven in vain, as it is written: You shall not curse the deaf (Leviticus 19:14), which prohibits all curses, even those using Gods name. Granted, if you say that Deuteronomy 28:59 is referring to cursing another, one can...
- **Temurah 4a:2** The Gemara counters: Why not, i.e., what is the difficulty? But isnt it written: You shall fear the Lord your God, and Him you shall serve (Deuteronomy 6:13)? Fearing God certainly includes not pronouncing His name in vain, and this verse can therefore serve as the warning. The Gemara answers: That verse is a warning stated a...
- **Berakhot 45a:7** Having mentioned these verses, the Gemara cites related matters. Rav anan bar Abba said: From where is it derived that one who answers amen should not raise his voice louder than the one reciting the blessing? As it is stated: Praise God with me, and we will exalt His Name together; together and not with the respondent raisin...

before fine-tuning:

- **Sanhedrin 63b:5** The Gemara answers: As it is taught in a baraita that the meaning of the verse: And make no mention of the name of the other gods, neither let it be heard out of your mouth (Exodus 23:13), is that a person may not say to another: Wait for me next to such and such an object of idol worship. The meaning of the statement neither...

9. When may the High Priest pronounce the name that nobody else may say?

nick-alexar.tex, The unpronounceable name
torah-embed:

- **Yoma 66a:11** And the priests and the people standing in the Temple courtyard, when they would hear the Explicit Name emerging from the mouth of the High Priest, when the High Priest did not use one of the substitute names for God, they would kneel and prostrate themselves and fall on their faces, and say: Blessed is the name of His glorious...
- **Kiddushin 71a:12** The Sages taught: Initially, the Sages would transmit the twelve-letter name of God to any person. When the uninhibited ones who used the name disrespectfully increased, they would transmit it only to discreet members of the priesthood, and the discreet members of the priesthood would pronounce the name during the Priestly Bened...
- **Yoma 19b:6** ğ It was taught in the mishna that Rabbi Zekharya ben Kevutal says: Many times I read before the High Priest from the book of Daniel. Rav anan bar Rava taught this to iyya bar Rav before Rav in the following manner: Rabbi Zekharya bar Kefutal said, and Rav demonstrated with his hand that the name should be pronounced Kevutal...

before fine-tuning:

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10. Why was an animal sacrificed in the Temple every single day?

nick-alexar.tex, Animal sacrifice
torah-embed:

- **Yoma 70a:18** Or perhaps this is what he is saying: The seven lambs were sacrificed with the daily morning offering and the bull of the Yom Kippur burnt-offering together with them, whereas the goat whose services are performed outside, i.e., in the Temple courtyard, was sacrificed with the daily afternoon offering....
- **Yoma 70a:17** GEMARA: It was taught in the mishna: Rabbi Akiva said the seven lambs were sacrificed with the daily morning offering; and the bull of the Yom Kippur burnt-offering; and the goat whose services are performed outside of the Sanctuary, i.e., in the Temple courtyard, with the daily afternoon offering. It is unclear whether the midd...
- **Chullin 22a:9** The Gemara objects: The halakha that the bird burnt offering is sacrificed only during the day is derived from the verse: In the day that he commanded the children of Israel to present their offerings (Leviticus 7:38), not from the halakha of the animal sin offering. The Gemara explains: The requirement of sacrificing the bird...

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11. What should you do if someone tries to set up an idol in the Temple?

nick-alexar.tex, Zeus in the Temple
torah-embed:

- **Avodah Zarah 52a:12** The Gemara asks: And the other tanna, Rabbi Yishmael, how does he interpret this verse? The Gemara answers: Rabbi Yishmael requires that verse for that which Rabbi Yitzak says, as Rabbi Yitzak says: From where is it derived that a Jews object of idol worship requires interment? This is derived from a verse, as it is stated: ...
- **Avodah Zarah 52a:11** The Gemara asks: And as for the opinion of Rabbi Akiva, we found a source for the halakha that a gentiles object of idol worship is prohibited immediately. From where do we derive that a Jews object of idol worship is not forbidden until it is worshipped? Rav Yehuda said that the verse states: Cursed be the man who shall make...
- **Avodah Zarah 50b:2** Rav Sheshet said: As for me, I am not a carpenter, nor am I the son of a carpenter, and yet I will resolve the difficulty. What is the difficulty that Rabba bar Yirmeya finds in the baraita? The baraita is difficult because of the statement of Rav Giddel, that the prohibited status of offerings brought in idol worship can never...

before fine-tuning:

- **Taanit 29a:1** You want to destroy the Temple; I have given you your hand. It is as though one idol said to the other: You are seeking to destroy the Temple by causing Israel to pray to you; I, too, give you a hand to assist you....

12. What happens to a Jew who marries out and forgets the religion?

nick-alexar.tex, Assimilation
torah-embed:

- **Yevamot 47b:15** The baraita continues: Once he has immersed and emerged he is a Jew in every sense. The Gemara asks: With regard to what halakha is this said? It is that if he reverts back to behaving as a gentile, he nevertheless remains Jewish, and so if he betroths a Jewish woman, although he is considered to be an apostate Jew, his betrotha...
- **Yevamot 78a:1** how could a second-generation Egyptian convert ever achieve purity, so that it is permitted for his offspring, the third generation, to enter into the congregation? He may marry neither a Jew nor a female Egyptian convert. The Gemara answers: Perhaps it means that if he transgressed and married a convert or a Jewish woman, his s...
- **Bekhorot 30b:3** It is also taught in a baraita (Tosefta, Demai 2:4): With regard to a convert who accepted upon himself upon his conversion matters of Torah, i.e., all of the mitzvot, even if he is suspect with regard to one matter alone, he is suspect with regard to the entire Torah, and he is considered like a Jewish transgressor [meshummad],...

before fine-tuning:

- **Pesachim 49a:13** The Gemara asks: What is meant by this statement that their union will be inauspicious? Rav isda said: The inauspicious nature of such a marriage can be identified based on the verse describing the return of a daughter of a priest to her fathers house after marrying a non-priest. The verse is understood as mentioning that the...

13. Is it right for a Jew to hide that they are Jewish in order to save their people?

nick-alexar.tex, Esther's choice
torah-embed:

- **Chagigah 5a:18** On the same topic the Gemara states: Then My anger shall be kindled against them in that day, and I will forsake them, and I will hide My face from them, and they shall be devoured (Deuteronomy 31:17). Rav Bardela bar Tavyumei said that Rav said: Anyone who is not subject to His hiding of the face, i.e., whose prayers are inva...
- **Menachot 43a:10** The Gemara asks: What is the reason for the prohibition against selling a cloak with ritual fringes to a gentile? The Gemara answers: Here they interpreted that it is prohibited because of the concern that the gentile will visit a prostitute and observers will think that he is a Jew. Alternatively, Rav Yehuda said: It is prohibi...
- **Avodah Zarah 22b:6** The Gemara answers: With regard to themselves, i.e., other gentiles, as they are aware of each others actions, they are fearful that they may be caught, and therefore will not engage in bestiality with an animal belonging to another gentile. But with regard to ourselves, Jews, as we are not aware of them and their behavior, the...

before fine-tuning:

- **Bava Batra 60b:21** But concerning a situation such as this, the following principle is applied: Leave the Jews alone and do not impose decrees by which they cannot abide. It is better that they be unwitting sinners, who do not know that what they are doing is improper considering the circumstances, and not be intentional wrongdoers, who marry and...

14. What does it mean to have struggled with God and with men, and prevailed?

nick-alexar.tex, The struggle with God
torah-embed:

- **Sanhedrin 89b:10** The Torah continues: And He said: Take, please [na], your son (Genesis 22:2). Rabbi Shimon bar Abba says: The word na is nothing other than an expression of entreaty. Why did God request rather than command that Abraham take his son? The Gemara cites a parable of a flesh-and-blood king who confronted many wars. And he had one...
- **Sanhedrin 101b:2** And it is written thereafter: And when he was in distress, he sought the Lord his God, and humbled himself greatly before the God of his fathers, and he prayed to Him and He was entreated of him, and He heard his supplication, and brought him back to Jerusalem into his kingdom; then Manasseh knew that the Lord He was God (II C...
- **Sotah 42a:11** The priest explains why the soldiers need not be terrified. For the Lord your God is He that goes with you, to fight for you against your enemies, to save you (Deuteronomy 20:4). Remember that they come to war championed by flesh and blood, and you are coming championed by the Omnipresent. The Philistines came championed by Go...

before fine-tuning:

- **Sanhedrin 107a:10** Rava taught: What is the meaning of that which is written: And when I limped they rejoiced and gathered, the wretched gather themselves together against me, and those whom I know not; they tore and did not cease [dammu] (Psalms 35:15)? David said before the Holy One, Blessed be He: Master of the Universe. It is revealed and kn...

15. Why do we read the story of Esther every year?

nick-alexar.tex, Purim
torah-embed:

- **Megillah 29b:20** However, according to the one who said that the portion of Command the children of Israel, and say to them, My offering is read as Shekalim, does that portion ever occur at that time of the year? That portion usually occurs much later in the year, in the summer. The Gemara answers: Yes, it sometimes occurs that this portion is...
- **Megillah 6b:28** Rabbi Elazar said: The reason for the opinion of Rabban Shimon ben Gamliel is derived from here, as it is written: To confirm this second letter of Purim (Esther 9:29), indicating that there are circumstances where the Megilla is read a second time (Jerusalem Talmud), i.e., when the year was intercalated after the Megilla was...
- **Megillah 7a:4** It was related that Rav and Rabbi anina and Rabbi Yoanan and Rav aviva taught the statement cited below. The Gemara comments: Throughout the order of Moed, wherever this latter pair of Sages is mentioned, exchange Rabbi Yoanan and insert Rabbi Yonatan in his place. They said: Esther sent to the Sages: Write me for future gen...

before fine-tuning:

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16. How should you treat a stranger who arrives at your tent?

nick-alexar.tex, The open tent
torah-embed:

- **Bava Metzia 86b:18** Despite the intense heat, Abraham wanted to invite guests. He sent Eliezer his slave to go outside to see if there were any passersby. Eliezer went out but did not find anyone. Abraham said to him: I do not believe you. The Gemara comments: This demonstrates the popular adage that people there, i.e., in Eretz Yisrael, say: Slave...
- **Bava Metzia 87a:7** The next verse states: And they said to him: Where is Sarah your wife? And he said: Behold, in the tent (Genesis 18:9). The Gemara explains that this verse serves to inform us that Sarah, our foremother, was a modest woman, as she remained inside while the guests were present. Rav Yehuda says that Rav says, and some say it is...
- **Sanhedrin 44a:19** The verse states: And it came to pass when Joshua was by Jericho that he lifted up his eyes and looked, and, behold, a man stood over against him with his sword drawn in his hand: And Joshua went to him and said to him, Are you for us or for our adversaries? And he said: No, but I am captain of the host of the Lord; I have now...

before fine-tuning:

- **Berakhot 6b:37** And Rabbi elbo said that Rav Huna said: One who is aware that another person is accustomed to greet him is not only obligated to return his greeting, but he must greet him first, as it is stated: Seek peace and pursue it (Psalms 34:15). If the other person extended his greeting to him and he did not respond, he is called a ro...

17. Is there something better about the life of a shepherd than the life of a farmer?

nick-alexar.tex, Nomads not farmers
torah-embed:

- **Temurah 15b:19** And that man himself also said at the time of his death: I know for a fact with regard to myself that I have no transgression attributable to me but the sin of keeping that goat in my house alone, as I transgressed the statement of my colleagues, the Sages. As the Sages said in a mishna (Bava Kamma 79b): One may not raise small...
- **Moed Katan 12a:11** The baraita continues: And one may not assist gentile shepherds in pasturing their sheep in his field so that it will be fertilized, nor may one provide them with a shepherd to help herd their sheep all around the field so that it is completely fertilized. If the gentile shepherds were hired by the week, by the month, by the yea...
- **Yevamot 63a:7** And Rabbi Elazar said: All craftsmen are destined to stand upon and work the land, as it is stated: And all that handle the oar, the mariners, and all the pilots of the sea, shall come down from their ships, they shall stand upon the land (Ezekiel 27:29). And Rabbi Elazar said: There is no occupation lowlier than working the l...

before fine-tuning:

- **Sanhedrin 25b:17** Rava says: The shepherd that the Sages said is disqualified from bearing witness is referring to both a shepherd of small livestock and a herder of large livestock....

18. How did the Jews keep their faith while they were captives in Babylon?

nick-alexar.tex, The Torah was written in Exile
torah-embed (top hit unchanged by fine-tuning):

- **Menachot 98a:10** There is a dispute with regard to this matter between Rav isda and Rav Yitzak bar Avdimi. One said that Shushan was depicted so that those who passed through the gate would know from where it was that they had come back to Jerusalem. The Jews returned once Persia had conquered Babylonia, and therefore they should give thanks t...
- **Megillah 29a:4** ğ It is taught in a baraita: Rabbi Shimon ben Yoai says: Come and see how beloved the Jewish people are before the Holy One, Blessed be He. As every place they were exiled, the Divine Presence went with them. They were exiled to Egypt, and the Divine Presence went with them, as it is stated: Did I reveal myself to the house of...
- **Arakhin 15a:16** And they also tried God when they ascended from the sea, in accordance with the opinion of Rav Huna, as Rav Huna says: The Jewish people of that generation, during the Exodus, were of little faith. This is in accordance with a statement of Rabba bar Mari. As Rabba bar Mari says: What is the meaning of that which is written: But...

19. Is the promise of the land conditional on how we behave towards each other?

unorthodox.txt II
torah-embed:

- **Bava Batra 100a:7** Rabbi Elazar said: What is the reasoning of Rabbi Eliezer? As it is written that after God promised Abraham Eretz Yisrael, He instructed him: Arise, walk through the land, its length and its breadth; for I will give it to you (Genesis 13:17), in order that Abraham should thereby acquire the land. And the Rabbis, how do they in...
- **Nedarim 11a:2** The Gemara says: Whose opinion is expressed in the mishna? If you say it is that of Rabbi Meir, he does not hold that from a negative statement you can infer a positive statement. As we learned in a mishna: Rabbi Meir says that any condition that is not like the condition of the sons of the tribe of Gad and the sons of the tribe...
- **Chullin 91b:12** The Gemara explains another verse from Jacobs dream. And behold, the Lord stood over him and said: I am the Lord, the God of Abraham your father and the God of Isaac. The land upon which you lie, to you will I give it, and to your seed (Genesis 28:13). The Gemara asks: What is the greatness of this promise, i.e., why is it ex...

before fine-tuning:

- **Ketubot 83b:1** in the case of one who immediately objects when the other comes to claim the portion he was promised, saying that he wrote what he did only in order to avoid a quarrel. However, in the case of one who waits while the other takes possession of the land before regretting his decision and requesting its return, the halakha is that...

20. Must Jews eat together even if they disagree?

unorthodox.txt II
torah-embed:

- **Bava Batra 137b:11** Rabbi Abba bar Memel said: And they do not disagree with each other:...
- **Pesachim 89b:4** The Gemara rejects this proof: They say: No, a comparison should not be drawn. Including additional people of individual minds is different. Even if both of them together would eat a quantity equivalent to a single member of the group, the other members of the group can nonetheless say to him: It is not pleasant for us to have a...

- **Berakhot 45b:8** The Gemara now attempts to prove the opposite: Rather, conclude that Rabbi Yoanan is the one who said: If they wanted to join together, they may not form a zimmun, as Rabba bar bar ana said that Rabbi Yoanan said: Two people who ate as one, one fulfills his obligation to recite a blessing o...

before fine-tuning:

- **Pesachim 115a:6** Rabbi Yoanan said: Hillels colleagues disagree with him, as it was taught in another baraita: I might have thought that one should wrap matzot and bitter herbs together and eat them in the manner that Hillel eats them; therefore the verse states: They shall eat it with matzot and bitter herbs, meaning that one may eat even t...

21. Does the covenant still hold?

unorthodox.txt II
torah-embed (top hit unchanged by fine-tuning):

- **Rosh Hashanah 17b:7** Rav Yehuda said: A covenant was made with the thirteen attributes that they will not return empty-handed, meaning that if one mentions them, he will certainly be answered, as it is stated in this regard: Behold, I make a covenant (Exodus 34:10)....
- **Gittin 60b:6** Rabbi Yoanan says: The Holy One, Blessed be He, made a covenant with the Jewish people only for the sake of the matters that were transmitted orally [beal peh], as it is stated: For on the basis of [al pi] these matters I have made a covenant with you and with Israel (Exodus 34:27)....
- **Sotah 37b:4** The baraita concludes: And there is no mitzva written in the Torah for which forty-eight covenants were not established....

22. Is the table where we eat a kind of temple?

unorthodox.txt II
torah-embed:

- **Menachot 98b:21** The Gemara replies: But according to your reasoning, the last question applies according to the one who said the tables were positioned from east to west as well: Where would one place the Table built by Moses? If the ten tables of Solomon occupied the entire twenty cubits of the inner half of the Sanctuary, how could Moses Tab...
- **Menachot 86b:6** Similarly, with regard to the Table of the shewbread, located in the north of the Sanctuary, and the Candelabrum, located in the south of the Sanctuary, Rabbi Zerika says that Rabbi Elazar says: God said to the Jewish people: I do not require the Table for eating, nor do I require the Candelabrum for its illumination. In evidenc...
- **Menachot 98b:20** And moreover, if the ten tables occupied the entire width of the Sanctuary, how would the High Priests pass them in order to enter the Holy of Holies on Yom Kippur? And moreover, if the tables were positioned in this manner we find that five of the ten tables were located in the south of the Sanctuary, whereas the Torah states t...

before fine-tuning:

- **Zevachim 56a:6** Rava said: The halakha concerning eating is different. The Torah specifically includes these chambers in addition to the Temple courtyard itself for eating offerings of the most sacred order. By contrast, with regard to slaughtering offerings of lesser sanctity and the punishment for entering the courtyard in a state of ritual i...

23. I see no friendship in anyone. What became of friends?

Hafez, Ghazal 255
torah-embed (top hit unchanged by fine-tuning):

- **Bava Batra 16b:5** The Gemara asks: How did they all know at the same time what had happened to Job so that the three of them came together? There are those who say that they each had a crown which displayed certain signs when something happened to one of the others. And there are those who say they each had trees and when the trees withered they...
- **Berakhot 63a:15** Several ethical tenets and guidelines for life were taught in a baraita. Rabbi Yehuda HaNasi says: One should never have too many friends in his house, i.e., people should not become accustomed to being overly intimate in his house, as it is stated: There are friends that one has to his own hurt (Proverbs 18:24); one with frie...
- **Sanhedrin 100b:7** Rather, perhaps the book poses a difficulty because it is written there: Prevent the multitudes from inside your house, and do not bring everyone into your house (Ben Sira 11:37). But didnt Rabbi Yehuda HaNasi also say it, as it is taught in a baraita that Rabbi Yehuda HaNasi says: A person should never have many friends inside...

24. If money is held in trust for someone, can a parent pressure them into signing it over?

personal correspondence
torah-embed:

- **Bava Metzia 49a:9** The Gemara asks: And if it enters your mind that reneging on a verbal commitment unaccompanied by an act of acquisition constitutes an act of bad faith, how did Rabbi Yoanan ben Matya tell his son to renege? The Gemara answers: This is not difficult; it is different there in that case, as the laborers themselves do not rely on...
- **Ketubot 46b:5** The Gemara asks: But one can say that the betrothal money should go to her, as one can derive from the verse that there is no money for this master but there is money for the woman herself when she leaves her fathers domain. The Gemara refutes this suggestion: Now consider, her father accepts her betrothal, i.e., he can accept...
- **Ketubot 69b:5** MISHNA: With regard to one who transfers money by means of a third party for his daughter to purchase a field after she marries, is the daughter allowed to assert control over the money? If she says after she marries: My husband is trustworthy for me, so give him the money to buy the property for me, her wishes are not honored....

before fine-tuning:

- **Kiddushin 29a:5** The Gemara answers: There is an additional impediment to reneging on an agreement with another commoner. Is that to say that a commoner who gave a seller money and changed his mind before acquiring the item is not forced to accept upon himself the curse of: He Who exacted payment from the generation of the flood (see Genesis, ch...

25. What is trust in God, and what does it mean to ask for it?

personal notes, on bitachon (trust)
torah-embed:

- **Berakhot 10b:1** Similarly, Rabbi anan said: Even if the master of dreams, in a true dream, an angel (Maayan HaBerakhot) tells a person that tomorrow he will die, he should not prevent himself from praying for mercy, as it is stated: For in the multitude of dreams and vanities there are many words; but fear God (Ecclesiastes 5:6). Although t...

- **Sotah 31a:3** ğ On that same day Rabbi Yehoshua ben Hyrcanus taught that Job served the Holy One, Blessed be He, only out of love, as it is stated: Though He will slay me, still I will trust in Him [lo] (Job 13:15). The mishna continues that the word lo in the verse is ambiguous as to whether it is indicative of Job expressing his yearning. . .
- **Sotah 48b:19** ğ The mishna states that from the time when the Second Temple was destroyed men of faith ceased. Rabbi Yitzak says: These are people who believe in the Holy One, Blessed be He, and place their trust in Him in all their ways. As it is taught in a baraita: Rabbi Eliezer the Great says that whoever has bread in his basket to eat t. . .

before fine-tuning:

- **Berakhot 8a:1** What is the meaning of that which is written: But as for me, let my prayer be unto You, Lord, in a time of favor; O God, in the abundance of Your mercy, answer me with the truth of Your salvation (Psalms 69:14)? It appears that the individual is praying that his prayers will coincide with a special time of Divine favor. When i. . .

26. What does it mean for a person's talents to be recognised and put to good use?

personal notes
torah-embed:

- **Bekhorot 5a:17** The Gemara rejects this proof: But perhaps the total amount of shekels does equal the amount of a talent, but the verse calculates the general amounts, i.e., the hundreds of talents, in talents, and the verse does not calculate the details, i.e., any amount less than one hundred talents, in talents, but in shekels.. . .
- **Taanit 10b:4** It is taught in another baraita: Not everyone who wishes to make himself an individual may do so, and nor may everyone who wishes to act like a student do so. This is the statement of Rabbi Shimon ben Elazar. Rabban Shimon ben Gamliel says: In what case is this statement said? It is said with regard to a matter of praise, e.g.,. . .
- **Keritot 3a:20** And if you say the mishna mentions these positive mitzvot to teach that one brings an offering for unwittingly failing to perform them, does one in fact bring an offering in such a case? But isnt it taught in a baraita: The entire Torah is juxtaposed to idolatry, as it is written: You shall have one law [torah] for him that do. . .

before fine-tuning:

- **Ketubot 28a:8** MISHNA: And these are deemed credible to testify in their majority with regard to what they saw in their minority. A person is deemed credible to say: This is my fathers handwriting, and to say: This is my teachers handwriting; and to say: This is my brothers handwriting, even though he never saw their handwriting after reach. . .